

Bob Richter

September 25, 2000

Red 11/18/00 wpl

To: Colorado Bird Records Committee

7-0 (A)

Re: Red Knot

To Whom It May Concern:

Between 8 am to 10 am, on Saturday 23 September 2000 I was birding by myself on the northeast side of Jackson Res., Morgan Co. The wind was blowing 25-mph +/-, and it was raining intermittently. The temperate was about 40 degrees with a wind chill factor much colder. I had walked from the parking lot, on the north side, to the dam so I could walk back towards the parking lot so as the wind and rain would be at my back.

About half way from the dam to the parking lot there was good concentration of shorebirds, most were Baird's Sandpipers with some Greater and Lesser Yellowlegs. About 30 yards away there was a small cluster of shorebirds standing in the water feeding. Six of those shorebirds were juv. Sanderlings, all were in various stages of molting to first basic. Feeding in this group was a larger shorebird. At first glance I thought the shorebird was a basic plumage Black-bellied Plover. My attention was alerted to this shorebird because it was not feeding in the typical Pluvialis, plover fashion, instead it was feeding like a Calidris sandpiper, its bill was penetrating the substrate like a slow sewing machine. Because it was feeding with its head mostly under water I could not see the head very well and could not see the bill at all. One feature that immediately stood out on this dun-gray colored bird was that the primary appeared contrastingly black in relation the back color which appeared gray and patternless. Focusing on the primary I could see there was a very noticeable primary extension beyond the end of the tertial. The primaries did not extend beyond the tail. The bird did pause from feeding and revealed its bill and head. On the side of the plain colored grayish head was a noticeable, short, whitish supercilary. Some Stilt Sandpipers moved into the scene. In comparing the two body sizes they were about equal. The body size of the Red Knot was just slightly bigger than some Lesser Yellowlegs, which were feeding a half a scope view away. The bill was proportionally much shorter than the Stilt, the legs were also proportionally shorter than the Stilts and much shorter than the Lesser Yellowlegs. Of course the Knot was much larger than the Sanderlings. The ventral side of the Knot was all whitish-gray. There were a few remnant, not obvious, dark streaks on the sides of the breast. Unfortunately I was just to far away and the light was not that good so I couldn't determine the age. As I was getting quite cold I left and therefore I never saw it fly. The Knot never emitted any sound

Respectively submitted,

Bob